

Erin A. York

CONTACT INFORMATION	Department of Political Science Vanderbilt University Commons Center, Nashville, TN 37212	<i>E-mail:</i> erin.a.york@vanderbilt.edu <i>Website:</i> eayork.github.io
ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS	Vanderbilt University , Nashville, TN C. Family Dean's Faculty Fellow Assistant Professor, Political Science Princeton University , Princeton, NJ Postdoctoral Fellow, Niehaus Center for Globalization and Governance Harvard University , Cambridge, MA Research Fellow, Middle East Initiative	2021-present 2020-2021 2019-2020
EDUCATION	Columbia University , New York, NY Ph.D., Political Science • Dissertation: <i>Democratic Institutions under Autocracy</i> M.Phil., Political Science M.A., Political Science Yale University , New Haven, CT B.S., Physics • <i>cum laude</i> , With Honors in the Major • Second Major: Near Eastern Languages and Civilizations	May 2020 May 2016 February 2015 May 2009
PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS	[1] with Eunji Kim, Unexpected Voices: How Cultural Agents Reshape Political Communication. <i>American Journal of Political Science</i>. <i>Accepted</i>. - Paul Lazarsfeld Best Paper Award (2026) [2] with Marwa Shalaby, Party Discipline and Women's Substantive Representation in Autocracies. <i>Journal of Women, Politics, and Policy</i>. <i>Forthcoming</i>. - Invited contribution to special issue on women's agency in political parties [3] with Daniel Tavana, Legislative Cooptation in Authoritarian Regimes: Policy Cooperation in the Kuwait National Assembly. <i>British Journal of Political Science</i> 55.e72 (2025). Link. - Best Paper Award (runner-up), King's College QPE Research Group (2021) - Regional coverage in the Arab Times (English) and Al-Seyassah (Arabic) newspapers [4] Constituency Service and Electoral Accountability in Autocratic Legislatures. <i>Comparative Political Studies</i> 58.8 (2025). Link. [5] Ministries matter: Technocrats and regime loyalty under autocracy. <i>Political Science Research and Methods</i> 12.1 (2024): 207-219. Link. [6] Preferences over Foreign Migration: Testing Existing Explanations in the Gulf. <i>World Politics</i> 74.3 (2022): 443-475. Link. [7] with Jacob Kopas and Johannes Urpelainen. Greasing the Wheels: The Politics of Environmental Clearances in India. <i>Studies in Comparative International Development</i> 57.1 (2022): 113-144. Link.	

- [8] with Tara Slough and Michael Ting, A Dynamic Model of Primaries. *Journal of Politics* 82.4 (2020): 1443-1457. [Link](#).
- [9] with Jacob Kopas, Xiaomeng Jin, S. P. Harish, Ryan Kennedy, Shiran Victoria Shen, and Johannes Urpelainen. Environmental Justice in India: Incidence of Air Pollution from Coal-Fired Power Plants. *Ecological Economics* 176 (2020): 106711. [Link](#).
- [10] with Daniel Corstange, Sectarian Framing in the Syrian Civil War. *American Journal of Political Science* 62.2 (2018): 441-455. [Link](#).
- Included in *AJPS - Highly-Cited Articles Collection*, April 1, 2019
- BOOK CHAPTERS [11] with Ben Noble, "Authoritarian Legislatures," in *Oxford Handbook on Authoritarian Politics*. Oxford University Press: *Forthcoming*.
- [12] with Daniel Corstange, "Clientelism, Constituency Service, and Elections," in *Oxford Handbook on Politics in Muslim Societies*. Oxford University Press: 2022.
- [13] with Donald P. Green, "Field Experiments in Political Behavior," in *The Routledge Handbook of Elections, Voting Behavior, and Public Opinion* (pp. 509-521), Routledge: 2018.
- POLICY [14] with Jeff Martini and William Young, Syria as an Arena of Strategic Competition, *RAND Corporation* (Santa Monica, CA: 2013).
- PUBLICATIONS [15] with Todd Helmus and Peter Chalk, Promoting Online Voices for Countering Violent Extremism, *RAND Corporation* (Santa Monica, CA: 2013).
- [16] with Jeff Martini and Dalia Dassa Kaye, Muslim Brotherhood Youth: Generational Divides and Implications for U.S. Engagement, *RAND Corporation* (Santa Monica, CA: 2012).
- RESEARCH IN [17] with Alicia Cooperman, Alexander Hamilton, Craig Hammer, and Tara Slough. *Monitoring & Evaluation Manual in Fragile States* (Book-length manuscript). *Under R&R*.
- PROGRESS [18] with Abhit Bhandari, Political Connections, Patronage, and Consumer Attitudes. *Under R&R*.
- [19] Politics 'By the Book:' Institutions, Service Provision, and Opposition Success under Authoritarianism. *In progress. Book workshop held January 2026*.
- [20] Cosponsorship and Collective Action in an Authoritarian Legislature. *In progress*.
- [21] with Daniel Tavana, Institutional Backlash: Assembly Dissolution and Snap Elections in Authoritarian Regimes. *In progress*.
- [22] Buying Autocratic Supermajorities. *In progress*.
- [23] with Chris Fariss, Google Trends for Global Research: A Cautionary Note. *In progress*.
- [24] Elections, Legislatures, and Power-sharing in Authoritarian Regimes *In progress*.
- AWARDS & EXTERNAL
FELLOWSHIPS APSA Political Communication Section
- Paul Lazarsfeld Best Paper Award, 2026
- Bright Data
- Bright Initiative Grant, 2024 (\$1500)

- National Science Foundation
- Graduate Research Fellowship, 2014–2017 (\$138000)
- Project on Middle East Political Science
- Travel Research Engagement Grant, 2016 (\$3000)
- U.S. Department of Education
- Foreign Language and Area Studies Fellowship (Arabic), 2015 (\$7500)
- U.S. Department of State
- Fulbright Fellowship, Damascus, Syria, 2009–2010
 - Critical Language Award (Arabic), 2009

INTERNAL

- Vanderbilt University
- Dean’s Research Studio Grant, 2026 (\$5,000)
 - Global Engagement Grant, 2025 (\$1,000)
 - Dean’s Faculty Fellowship, 2022-2024 (\$30,000)
 - Course Improvement Grant, 2022 (\$500)
- Columbia University
- Dissertation Development Fellowship, 2016, 2017 (\$5300)
 - Katerina Alevizaki Dracopoulos Summer Fellowship, 2016, 2017 (\$6750)
 - Middle East Institute Research Fellowship, 2014 (\$750)
 - Graduate Fellowship, Institute for Comparative Literature and Society, 2013 - 2016
 - Dean’s Fellowship, 2013
- Yale University
- Bensinger Prize, 2009 (\$3000)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- USAID Democracy, Human Rights, and Governance**
Contracted by NORC
Impact Evaluation Specialist February 2015 to June 2019
- World Bank**
Consultant August 2016 to December 2017
- RAND Corporation, Washington, DC**
Adjunct Researcher August 2013 to June 2015
Research Associate June 2011 to August 2013
- Project on Middle East Democracy, Washington, DC**
Research Assistant January to June 2011
- Arabic and Middle Eastern Electronic Library, Yale University**
Digitization Specialist May 2006 to May 2009

CONFERENCES, WORKSHOPS, & INVITED TALKS

- 2026: “Politics of Authoritarian Regimes” workshop (SPSA); Research on Behavior and Institutions conference (Vanderbilt University); Visions in Methodology conference (Hertie School); *Scheduled*: Yale University Comparative Politics Workshop; Women in Legislative Studies conference; APSA
- 2025: “Politics of Authoritarian Regimes” workshop (SPSA); University of Rochester Wallis Institute of Political Economy; Project on Middle East Political Science (POMEPS) virtual workshop; EPSA; APSA; Virtual Workshop on Authoritarian Regimes
- 2024: “Politics of Authoritarian Regimes” workshop (SPSA); EPSA; APSA; Women in Legislative Studies conference (University of Wisconsin-Madison)

2023: SPSA; Copenhagen Business School “Money in Politics” conference; EPSA; APSA; Women in Legislative Studies conference (Brown University)

2022: European Political Science Association annual meeting; International Society of Political Psychology (ISPP) annual meeting, APSA

2021: Princeton University Workshop on Arab Political Development; Association for Analytic Learning about Islam and Muslim Societies (AALIMS); Princeton University IR Colloquium; SPSA; APSA; Middle East Studies Association (MESA) annual meeting

2020: Harvard Kennedy School; Virtual Workshop on Authoritarian Regimes (VWAR); Project on Middle East Political Science (POMEPS) virtual workshop; SPSA

2019: Vanderbilt University; APSA

2017: Formal Theory and Comparative Politics Conference (Emory); Project on Middle East Political Science (POMEPS) annual conference; Winter Experimental Social Sciences Institute (NYU Abu Dhabi); APSA

2016: AUB-Bobst-Princeton “After the Uprisings” (Princeton); MPSA; APSA

TEACHING

Vanderbilt University, undergraduate

- The Politics of Autocracy
- Understanding Policy Data
- Political Science Honors Seminar (Thesis capstone course)

Vanderbilt University, graduate

- Comparative Authoritarianism

Columbia University, graduate

- Math review course for incoming students, 2018 and 2019

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Chair, Best Dissertation Award Committee, APSA Democracy & Autocracy (2025)

Coordinator, Vanderbilt University Comparative Politics Workshop (2023-2024)

Coordinator, Columbia University Political Science Methods Workshop (2014-2016)

Referee, *American Political Science Review*, *Journal of Conflict Resolution*, *Democratization*, *Studies in Comparative International Development*, *Comparative Politics*, *World Politics*, *American Journal of Political Science*, *British Journal of Middle Eastern Studies*, *Journal of Information Technology and Politics*, *Political Behavior*, *Comparative Political Studies*, *British Journal of Political Science*

EXPERTISE

Languages: Arabic (advanced) - MSA and Levantine Colloquial

French (advanced)

Spanish (intermediate)

Farsi (beginning-intermediate)

Computing: R, Stata, Selenium, JMP, L^AT_EX, ArcGIS